

Building Strong Relationships

The Purpose of Building Relationships:

- Create enduring connections
- Gain quick entry to resources when you need them, professionally and personally:
 - knowledge,
 - opportunities, and
 - support
- Stay current and know what's going on in your functional area, industry, and company

The Virtuous Circle of Relationship Building:

- It makes you more visible
- This visibility increases your influence/power and status
- Your heightened power and status make building and maintaining relationships easier – and you have more access to connecting with others

Leveraging Your Network:

- Understand your purpose for connecting
- Identify individuals you know who can help you fulfill that purpose and reach out to them
- For the gaps in your network, find people who can be a bridge to those you can help you
- Help others now and in the future
 - Actively search for ways to assist others
 - Follow through

Next Steps:

- Analyze your network
- Identify and determine ways to bridge gaps in your network
- Decide where you can add value to your network
- Listen to some of the CareerCast podcasts
- Practice:
 - Anywhere, but especially with peers
 - Through Booth and Career Services programs
 - At professional association events
 - During your travels
 - In your community

Resources:

Online:

- Research by Contacts: [Career Services > Conduct Research > Career Research Steps > Contacts](#)

- Networking Resources: Career Services > Changing Companies Functions Industries > Networking
- CRC Online Catalog of Books and DVDs: <http://opac.libraryworld.com/opac/home.php>
- Regenstein Library:
 - Business and Economic Resources: <http://guides.lib.uchicago.edu/alumni>
- CareerCast: (<http://career.chicagobooth.edu/careercast/>)
 - *Building Career Advocates* – Adam Grant
 - *Building Enduring Relationships for Success* – Ken Mortensen
 - *Building Relationships for a Lifetime of Success* – Bob Burg
 - *Connecting with Influence* – Michael J. Gelb
 - *Enhancing Personal Brand* – Fredrik Haren
 - *Expand Your Success with Reciprocal Relationships* – Melissa Giovagnoli
 - *Influence: The Art of Getting Others to Follow Your Lead* – Terry Bacon
 - *Making Your Networking Relationships Stick* – Diane Darling
 - *Relationship Building: The Power of Connectional Intelligence* – Erica Dhawan
 - *Relationships: Purposeful, Passionate, and Practical* – Guy Kawasaki
 - *Tell a Compelling Career Transition Story and Change Your Life* – Duncan Mathison
 - *Your Career Story: Communicating to Influence* – Ben Decker

Books:

- *Con conversationally Speaking: Tested New Ways to Increase Your Personal and Social Effectiveness* – Alan Garner
- *Give and Take* – Adam Grant
- *How to Talk to Anyone: 92 Little Tricks for Big Success in Relationships* – Leil Lowndes
- *How to Win Friends and Influence People in the Digital Age* – Dale Carnegie & Associates
- *Kiss, Bow, or Shake Hands: How to Do Business in Sixty Countries* – Terri Morrison and Wayne A. Conaway
- *Never Eat Alone* – Keith Ferrazzi
- *One Phone Call Away: Secrets of a Master Networker* – Doug Garr and Jeff Meshel
- *The Art of Connection* – Michael J. Gelb
- *The Virtual Handshake: Opening Doors and Closing Deals Online* – David Teten and Scott Allen

General:

- Book a career coaching appointment via GTS or boothworks@ChicagoBooth.edu or 312-464-8677